# Unofficial Definitions of Italian Corporate Structure Designations

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Some of the corporate structure designations in the Italian firm database may be unfamiliar and difficult to find online. Some of these are rare designations. I consulted my colleague, a professor of Finance in Italy, for his preferred definitions of these and learned that some are unusual even to him. Nonetheless, he provided unofficial interpretations, which I have reproduced, below, with only light editing.

## COMPANIES OBLIGED TO PUBLISH A BALANCE SHEET:

- **SRL**: *Società a Responsabilità Limitata* : Private Limited Company
  - min cap 10K euros

- **SRS**: *Società a Responsabilità limitata Semplificata* : Private Limited Company
  - simplified structure
  - min cap less than 10K

- **SRU**: "U" is unusual.
  - Probably similar to SRL but
  - “U” stands for "a socio unico" ("with only one shareholder")

- **SPA**: *Società per Azioni* : Public Limited Company

## COMPANIES NOT OBLIGED TO PUBLISH A BALANCE SHEET:

- **SAA**: *Società in Accomandita per Azion*i: Limited Partnership with two classes of shareholders:
  - *accomandanti*
    - cannot be managers
    - liable only for invested capital
  - *accomandatari*
    - managers
    - personally liable

- **SAU**: unclear what the "U" stands for. Could be "Unico" ("only one"); might refers to a company with only a single limited or unlimited shareholder.